

9. The Directive Principles of State Policy

Contents

9.1 Meaning of Directive Principles of State Policy	1
1. Socialistic Directives	2
2. Gandhian Directives.....	2
3. Liberal Intellectual Directives.....	2
9.2 Features of Directive Principles of State Policy	2
Other Key Features:	2
9.3 Implementation of the Directive Principles of State Policy	3
Key Implementations:.....	3

9.1 Meaning of Directive Principles of State Policy

- Articles 36–51 of the Indian Constitution are called the Directive Principles of State Policy.
- These are broad rules or instructions for the government to follow while making laws and policies.
- The government (both law-making and executive powers) must act according to these principles.
- After India became Independent, the Constitution makers knew that the economy was weak and the country's unity was fragile.
- So, they added these guidelines (Directive Principles) to help in the overall growth and progress of society.
- These ideas were inspired by the Constitution of Ireland. Their purpose is the complete development of India.
- They cover areas like social justice, economic growth, foreign relations, and legal or administrative matters.
- These principles cannot be enforced in court. The government cannot be punished for not following them.
- Directive Principles are divided into three main types:

1. Socialistic Directives

- Focus on the welfare of people.
- Equal sharing of resources.
- Protecting children's and youth's rights.
- Equal pay for equal work.
- Education for all.

2. Gandhian Directives

- Organizing village Panchayats.
- Prohibiting harmful drinks and cow slaughter.
- Giving people a fair wage and good living conditions.
- Supporting small industries and cottage industries.
- Free education for children up to 14 years.

3. Liberal Intellectual Directives

- Rules for fair and equal civil laws across the country.
- Guidance for the government in making laws or orders.

9.2 Features of Directive Principles of State Policy

- Directive Principles give important guidelines for the government.
- The government should work for the welfare of the people.
- Maintain peace and fairness in social, economic, and political matters.
- Work to reduce economic inequality.
- Remove unfair differences in status and opportunities.
- Provide enough livelihood for citizens.

Other Key Features:

- Equal work opportunities for both men and women.
- Avoid concentration of wealth in a few hands; distribute resources fairly among all sections of society.
- Stop child abuse and exploitation of workers.

- Protect children from neglect and abandonment.
- Provide free legal help for poor people so they can get justice.
- Set up Village Panchayats as self-governing bodies to deliver justice.
- Help the needy – unemployed, sick, disabled, and elderly.
- Ensure safe working conditions and fair wages.
- Encourage small-scale and cottage industries in villages.
- Work towards one common civil law for all Indian citizens.
- Free and compulsory education for children below 14 years.
- Improve the education and economy of Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes, and weaker sections.
- Ban alcoholic drinks, harmful drugs, and cow slaughter.
- Protect the environment, forests, and wildlife.
- Safeguard monuments, heritage places, and objects of cultural and historical value.
- Promote international peace and security.
- Follow international law, respect treaties, and solve disputes through peaceful arbitration.

9.3 Implementation of the Directive Principles of State Policy

- Unlike Fundamental Rights, Directive Principles are not legally enforceable in court.
- Still, the government has tried to implement them in many areas.

Key Implementations:

- Education: The 86th Constitutional Amendment (2002) added Article 21-A, which made free education for children below 14 years a fundamental right.
- Taxation Reforms: The Taxation Inquiry Commission (1953–1954) was set up to suggest tax reforms and reduce inequalities of income and wealth.
- Industrial Development: The Industrial Development and Regulation Act (1954) and the Monopolies Inquiry Commission (1965) aimed to stop unfair monopolies and promote balanced growth.
- Monopolies Commission: It studied the causes of concentration of wealth in few private hands and suggested measures to prevent harmful effects on the economy and society.

- Land Reforms: In the 1950s, land reform laws abolished landlordism and set limits on land ownership. Surplus land was distributed to weaker sections of society.
- Ceiling on Landholding: Many states made laws to stop individuals from owning too much land.
- Village Panchayats: Many states created laws to form Panchayats, encouraging local self-government.
- Community Development Programme (1952): A large program was launched to improve rural areas in sectors like communication, transport, housing, health, agriculture, and education.
- Prohibition of Alcohol and Drugs: Following Article 47, most states have passed laws to control or ban alcohol and harmful drugs.
- Cultural Protection: Laws have been made to protect important monuments and places of national importance.
- Separation of Powers: Following Article 50, steps have been taken to separate the powers of the judiciary from the executive.
- Employment Guarantee: The National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (NREGA) was passed to provide jobs and financial assistance to rural households.